

D393

History of Healthcare in America

Armored Drill

8 concepts · 12 items · 4 transfer items

What this is. Every concept in this course's public description, re-asked with more disguise than a practice test uses. Each stem carries facts that do not decide it. Every wrong answer is a named trap.

Source. Scope from the course's public description in the WGU Institutional Catalog (September 2026); items written from the field's standard body of knowledge. No WGU assessment item, course material or proprietary content is used or reproduced. Not affiliated with or endorsed by Western Governors University.

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How to run it

Paper first. Pencil. One pass, no notes, a timer if you want the pressure.

1. **Before you read the options**, fill the strip under the item: the target word (what is actually being asked), and the one fact in the stem that decides it.
2. **Principle before arithmetic**. Name the rule, then compute.
3. **Camouflage**. Most of every stem does not matter. Ask: which single fact decides this?
4. **Inverse pairs are the bait**. If two options are opposites, one of them is the trap built for you.
5. **Mark sure, unsure or guess** honestly. Sure-and-wrong is the most valuable miss on the page — it is a wrong mental model.
6. **Absolutes** (always, never, guarantee) are usually wrong. And recognizing an answer is not the same as owning it.
7. Items with a **heavy black bar** on the left are **transfer items**: the same principle, reversed or solved for a different variable.
8. Stop at the STOP page. Then grade, fill the triage grid, and tally the traps you fell for. The biggest tally is what you drill next.

The strip, filled in, looks like this:

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	_____	

Items

1.

A modern biotech firm with offices in three countries builds a profitable product using a cell line taken decades ago from a patient who was never told her cells were kept. The firm's stock rose 40% last year. Which historical case does this most closely echo, and what principle does it raise?

- A. Henrietta Lacks — informed consent and fair treatment in the use of human tissue.
- B. Ryan White — stigma against patients with HIV.
- C. Henrietta Lacks — insider trading rules for medical companies.
- D. Tuskegee — withholding treatment from research subjects.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

2. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A research ethics class uses one case to discuss who should benefit when a patient's cells produce decades of scientific and commercial value. Which person's story is the classic example?

- A. Katie Beckett
- B. Henrietta Lacks
- C. Clara Barton
- D. Ryan White

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

3.

A 30-year-old man with HIV works part-time at a bookstore and has no health insurance. He lives in a mid-sized city with two large hospitals. Which federal program is designed to fill this gap in his HIV care?

- A. Medicare, because HIV is a disability.
- B. The hospitals' charity care, since federal HIV funds only cover research.
- C. The Katie Beckett option.
- D. The Ryan White HIV/AIDS Program.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

4.

After a major flood displaces 5,000 residents of a river town, volunteers set up shelters, hand out food, and run blood drives. The town's mayor was elected last spring. Which historical figure founded the U.S. organization most associated with this kind of relief?

- A. Florence Nightingale
- B. Clara Barton, as the first director of the federal disaster agency.
- C. Ryan White
- D. Clara Barton

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

5.

A 4-year-old on a ventilator has been in the hospital for a year. Her doctors say she could live at home with nursing support, which would cost less. Her parents both work and earn too much for Medicaid. She has an older brother in second grade. Which policy lets her state cover her care at home?

- A. The Ryan White CARE Act.
- B. None; Medicaid always counts parents' income for children.
- C. Medicare, because she needs a ventilator.
- D. The Katie Beckett (TEFRA) option, which ignores parental income for children who need institutional-level care at home.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

6. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

Before the early 1980s, Medicaid rules often meant a disabled child kept coverage only by staying in a hospital. What did the change associated with Katie Beckett do?

- A. Allowed states to cover such children at home without counting parents' income.
- B. Paid for home care only for older adults.
- C. Required all disabled children to stay in hospitals for coverage.
- D. Created Medicare coverage for children.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

7.

A university hospital proposes a study that would withhold a proven treatment from some patients without telling them. The study's lead scientist has published 200 papers. Which historical case led to the review system that should stop this study?

- A. Ryan White, which led to informed consent rules.
- B. The Tuskegee syphilis study, which led to the Belmont Report and IRB review.
- C. None; a scientist with a strong record can approve his own study.
- D. Henrietta Lacks, which led to IRB review.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

8. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

The Belmont Report names three principles. Which one most directly requires informed consent?

- A. Respect for persons
- B. Nonmaleficence
- C. Beneficence
- D. Justice

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

9.

In 1966, hundreds of Southern hospitals that had kept separate wards by race integrated within months. Many of those hospitals were small and rural. What drove the speed of this change?

- A. A single Supreme Court case ordered every hospital to integrate that year.
- B. Rural hospitals had too few patients to keep separate wards.
- C. Medicare required hospitals to comply with the Civil Rights Act to get paid.
- D. Hospitals integrated slowly on their own over the next thirty years.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

10.

A hospital that has served its city for 90 years begins losing money when more heart failure patients return within 30 days. It has a new electronic health record system. Under value-based payment, why does this hurt the hospital?

- A. Readmitted patients are never covered by insurance.
- B. The new record system costs more when patients return.
- C. Medicare reduces payments to hospitals with higher-than-expected readmissions.
- D. Each readmission is a new paid stay, so readmissions always increase revenue.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

11. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

Which payment approach rewards a provider group for keeping a population healthy at lower total cost?

- A. Fee-for-service.
- B. An accountable care organization with shared savings.
- C. Paying per hospital bed filled.
- D. Charging patients higher copays.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

12.

A student asks why most working Americans get insurance from their employer while many other wealthy nations do not tie coverage to jobs. The student's own employer has 50 staff. What is the historical reason?

- A. Federal law requires every employer to offer insurance.
- B. The ACA created employer coverage in 2010.
- C. Wartime wage controls pushed employers to offer health benefits, and later tax rules made those benefits tax-free.
- D. Medicare required employers to provide coverage in 1965.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

STOP

Answers and dissection follow. Finish every item and every strip first.

Key and dissection

Struck-through text is the camouflage: facts that do not decide the item.

1. Answer A Concept 1

A modern biotech firm ~~with offices in three countries~~ builds a profitable product using a cell line taken decades ago from a patient who was never told her cells were kept. ~~The firm's stock rose 40% last year.~~ Which historical case does this most closely echo, and what principle does it raise?

Target word: historical parallel and principle **Decides:** Cells taken and used without the patient's knowledge.

A	Correct	HeLa cells were taken without her knowledge and used widely for research and profit.
B	Adjacent category	A different civil rights and funding issue.
C	Camouflage	Picks up the stock detail, which does not decide the principle.
D	Confusion set	Tuskegee withheld treatment; the stem is about tissue used without consent.

2. Answer B Concept 1 • transfer

A research ethics class uses one case to discuss who should benefit when a patient's cells produce decades of scientific and commercial value. Which person's story is the classic example?

Target word: reverse: principle to person **Decides:** Tissue use and benefit sharing.

A	Confusion set	Her case concerns Medicaid home care for children.
B	Correct	Her HeLa cells are the classic case for tissue consent and benefit sharing.
C	Adjacent category	Her legacy is disaster relief and the Red Cross.
D	Confusion set	His legacy is HIV stigma and the CARE Act.

3. Answer D Concept 2

A 30-year-old man with HIV works part-time at a bookstore and has no health insurance. ~~He lives in a mid-sized city with two large hospitals.~~ Which federal program is designed to fill this gap in his HIV care?

Target word: program fit **Decides:** HIV care for an uninsured person — payer of last resort.

A	Absolute language	HIV alone does not create Medicare eligibility; that requires age 65 or qualifying disability status.
B	Inverted operation	Reverses the program's purpose; Ryan White funds care, not only research.
C	Confusion set	That Medicaid option covers children with disabilities at home.
D	Correct	It funds HIV medical care and support for people with no or insufficient coverage.

4. Answer D Concept 3

After a major flood displaces 5,000 residents of a river town, volunteers set up shelters, hand out food, and run blood drives. ~~The town's mayor was elected last spring.~~ Which historical figure founded the U.S. organization most associated with this kind of relief?

Target word: founder of organized disaster relief **Decides:** Volunteer shelters and blood drives — the Red Cross.

A	Confusion set	Founded modern nursing training in Britain, not the American Red Cross.
B	Dropped element	Right person, wrong institution; she founded a volunteer organization, not a federal agency.
C	Adjacent category	His legacy is HIV policy.
D	Correct	She founded the American Red Cross in 1881.

5. Answer D Concept 4

A 4-year-old on a ventilator has been in the hospital for a year. Her doctors say she could live at home with nursing support, which would cost less. Her parents both work and earn too much for Medicaid. ~~She has an older brother in second grade.~~ Which policy lets her state cover her care at home?

Target word: policy fit **Decides:** Child with disability; parental income would otherwise block Medicaid at home.

A	Confusion set	Funds HIV care, not pediatric home care.
B	Absolute language	The Katie Beckett option exists precisely to disregard parental income.
C	Adjacent category	Medicare is for older adults and certain disabled adults, not young children.
D	Correct	This is the problem the Katie Beckett case solved.

6. Answer A Concept 4 • transfer

Before the early 1980s, Medicaid rules often meant a disabled child kept coverage only by staying in a hospital. What did the change associated with Katie Beckett do?

Target word: reverse: from name to effect **Decides:** Shifted coverage from institution to home.

A	Correct	It moved care from institutions to the community.
B	Confusion set	The option targets children.
C	Inverted operation	That was the problem, not the fix.
D	Adjacent category	Medicare was not extended to children.

7. Answer B Concept 5

A university hospital proposes a study that would withhold a proven treatment from some patients without telling them. ~~The study's lead scientist has published 200 papers.~~ Which historical case led to the review system that should stop this study?

Target word: origin of research oversight **Decides:** Withholding treatment without consent.

A	Adjacent category	His legacy is HIV funding and stigma, not research oversight.
B	Correct	Tuskegee withheld treatment and deceived participants; outrage produced modern protections.
C	Camouflage	His publication record is irrelevant; independent review is required.
D	Confusion set	Her case concerns tissue use; IRBs grew from the Tuskegee response.

8. Answer A Concept 5 • transfer

The Belmont Report names three principles. Which one most directly requires informed consent?

Target word: reverse: principle for a practice **Decides:** Consent protects autonomy.

A	Correct	Respect for persons requires treating people as autonomous and getting informed consent.
B	Adjacent category	A clinical ethics principle; Belmont folds harm-avoidance into beneficence.
C	Confusion set	Beneficence is about maximizing benefit and minimizing harm.
D	Confusion set	Justice is about fair selection of subjects and sharing burdens.

9. Answer C Concept 6

In 1966, hundreds of Southern hospitals that had kept separate wards by race integrated within months. ~~Many of these hospitals were small and rural.~~ What drove the speed of this change?

Target word: mechanism **Decides:** Federal payment tied to Title VI compliance.

A	Adjacent category	Courts played a role, but the speed came from Medicare payment rules.
B	Camouflage	Seizes on the size detail; the lever was federal payment.
C	Correct	Tying new Medicare money to Title VI compliance forced rapid integration.
D	Inverted operation	The change happened within months, not decades.

10. Answer C Concept 7

A hospital ~~that has served its city for 90 years~~ begins losing money when more heart failure patients return within 30 days. ~~It has a new electronic health record system.~~ Under value-based payment, why does this hurt the hospital?

Target word: why readmissions matter **Decides:** Payment is tied to outcomes, and excess readmissions are penalized.

A	Absolute language	Readmissions are covered; the penalty is on the hospital's payments.
B	Camouflage	The record system is irrelevant to the payment rule.
C	Correct	The Hospital Readmissions Reduction Program ties payment to quality.
D	Inverted operation	That is fee-for-service logic, which value-based penalties reverse.

11. Answer B Concept 7 • transfer

Which payment approach rewards a provider group for keeping a population healthy at lower total cost?

Target word: reverse: goal to model **Decides:** Shared savings for quality and cost.

A	Inverted operation	Pays more for more services, not better results.
B	Correct	ACOs share savings when quality is met and cost falls.
C	Confusion set	Rewards volume, like fee-for-service.
D	Adjacent category	Cost sharing shifts cost; it is not a provider payment model.

12. Answer C Concept 8

A student asks why most working Americans get insurance from their employer while many other wealthy nations do not tie coverage to jobs. ~~The student's own employer has 50 staff.~~ What is the historical reason?

Target word: origin of employer coverage **Decides:** World War II wage controls plus tax treatment.

A	Absolute language	Only larger employers face ACA penalties, and the system predates the ACA.
B	Inverted operation	The ACA added rules to a system that had existed for decades.
C	Correct	Benefits were a way to compete for workers when raises were capped.
D	Adjacent category	Medicare covers older adults; it did not create employer coverage.

Triage grid

Write each item number in the box it belongs to.

	Right	Wrong
Sure	Owned.	Concept inversion — top priority. A wrong mental model; it survives rewording.
Unsure / guess	Recognition, not mastery. Re-drill with the transfer.	Not learned yet.

Trap tally

For every miss, find the letter you chose in the key and tally its trap. The biggest number is the pattern to drill.

Trap	What it does	In this drill	Your misses
Dropped element	Leaves out a required term or step.	1	
Wrong stem number	A figure copied from the prompt that is not the answer.	0	
Adjacent category	The right idea in the wrong bucket.	10	
Inverted operation	Direction flipped: add/subtract, cause/effect, higher/lower.	6	
Absolute language	Always, never, guarantee — where judgment applies.	4	
Confusion set	Every option is real; the test is exact role-matching.	11	
Camouflage	Answers a stem fact that was never the question.	4	

Anchor rows — the concept list

One row per concept: the rule to lock in, the trap that catches people, and the tell in the question that signals it.

#	Concept	Rule	Trap	Tell
1	Henrietta Lacks and consent for tissue use	Cells taken from Henrietta Lacks in 1951 without her knowledge became the HeLa line; her case anchors today's debates on informed consent, tissue ownership, and sharing benefits with patients and families.	Remembering her case as a treatment-withholding experiment like Tuskegee.	Cells, tissue, samples, or a family learning later that their relative's biology was used.
2	Ryan White and the federal HIV safety net	Ryan White, a teenager with hemophilia who got HIV from a blood product and was barred from school, gave his name to the 1990 CARE Act, which funds HIV care for people who are uninsured or underinsured as a payer of last resort.	Thinking the Ryan White program is general insurance for everyone with HIV, or that it came from a vaccine law.	HIV care for someone with no or not enough coverage; stigma in schools.
3	Clara Barton and organized disaster relief	Clara Barton nursed soldiers in the Civil War and founded the American Red Cross in 1881, building the U.S. model of organized volunteer disaster and emergency relief.	Crediting her with founding professional nursing schools or a government health agency.	Disaster response, volunteers, or battlefield care in the 1800s.
4	Katie Beckett and home-based care	Katie Beckett's case led to a 1982 Medicaid option that lets states cover children with serious disabilities at home without counting parents' income, shifting care from institutions to the community.	Believing Medicaid could always pay for home care, or that the waiver is for older adults.	A child who could go home but would lose coverage by leaving the hospital.
5	Tuskegee and research protections	The Public Health Service syphilis study (1932–1972) withheld treatment from Black men without informed consent; public outcry led to the National Research Act, the Belmont Report (respect for persons, beneficence, justice), and IRB review.	Thinking IRBs and the Belmont Report existed before Tuskegee or came from the Lacks case.	Withheld treatment, deception of participants, or where modern research oversight came from.
6	Medicare and hospital desegregation	When Medicare began in 1966, hospitals had to comply with Title VI of the Civil Rights Act to receive payment, which quickly desegregated most U.S. hospitals.	Believing hospital desegregation came only from court rulings or happened gradually over decades.	Federal money tied to civil rights compliance in the mid-1960s.

#	Concept	Rule	Trap	Tell
7	From volume to value	Fee-for-service pays for each service; value-based models (ACOs, readmission penalties, bundled payments) tie payment to quality and cost, a shift accelerated by the 2010 Affordable Care Act.	Thinking fee-for-service rewards outcomes or that value-based care means paying less for the same volume.	Payment linked to results, readmissions, or shared savings.
8	Why U.S. insurance is tied to jobs	During World War II, wage controls led employers to offer health benefits instead of raises, and later tax rules excluded employer premiums from income, locking in employer-based coverage.	Assuming employer coverage was created by a federal mandate or by Medicare.	A question about the origin of job-based insurance.

Course scope (public description): History of Healthcare in America will examine individuals such as Henrietta Lacks, Ryan White, Clara Barton, and Katie Beckett, who influenced healthcare in the United States, from its inception to the present day. This course examines how specific individuals and their contributions influenced healthcare delivery and the continued evolution of healthcare, teaching from a system or a value-based care perspective. The course also focuses on the way healthcare interacted with culture, politics, and society throughout U.S. history and evaluates current challenges we face in the U.S. healthcare system today. There are no prerequisites for this course.